

AISH and ADAP: Key Features for Single Clients

Verified and current, July 2026. The transition is in force. This replaces the older “proposed” chart going around.

Feature	AISH before July 2026	AISH now (revised)	ADAP (new program)
Who it is for	Severe disability that substantially limits the ability to earn a living.	Severe disability that permanently prevents employment. Assessed as unable to work.	Severe disability that substantially impedes employment. Assessed as able to work.
How you are assessed	AISH application plus AISH medical report. AISH staff decide.	One combined Disability Assistance application plus a Disability Assistance Medical Report (DAMR). The Medical Review Panel reviews inability to work.	The same combined application. An adjudicator decides work capability.
Maximum monthly benefit (single)	\$1,940	\$1,940	\$1,740. Clients moved from AISH are held at \$1,940 by a \$200 top-up until Dec 31, 2027.
Earnings exemption (single)	\$1,072 per month	\$350 per month	\$700 per month
Above the exemption	50% reduction from \$1,073 to about \$2,009, then 100% above about \$2,010.	100% clawback. Every dollar above \$350 comes off dollar for dollar.	Gradual reduction, rising to full deduction at about \$45,240 in annual income.
Employment supports	Limited. Not employment-focused.	Limited. Not employment-focused.	Individualized supports: assessments, referrals, employment plans, case management. Run by outside contractors, AKG in Edmonton and the north, Serco in Calgary and the south. No employer-side obligations.
Health benefits	Continue while on AISH.	Kept to age 65, even if earnings exceed the threshold.	Kept to age 65, even if earnings exceed the threshold.
Inflation indexing	Automatic annual increase (the legislated Alberta escalator).	No longer automatic. Set by government regulation, and not guaranteed.	No longer automatic. Set by government regulation, and not guaranteed.
Appeals: money and benefits (non-medical)	Citizen's Appeal Panel.	Citizen's Appeal Panel. Covers living allowance, health benefits, child benefit, personal benefits.	Citizen's Appeal Panel. Covers living allowance, health benefits, child benefit, personal benefits.
Appeals: which program you land on (medical)	Could be appealed.	The Medical Review Panel decides, and its decision is final and cannot be appealed .	The Medical Review Panel decides, and its decision is final and cannot be appealed .

Read this before you rely on any comparison chart

There is no “ADAP Medical Appeal Panel.” That body does not exist in any government document. The Medical Review Panel makes the AISH-versus-ADAP decision, and it is final. The way back to AISH is not an appeal, it is a reassessment, and reassessment has no deadline.

Compiled from Government of Alberta and Alberta Health Services sources and the AISH General Regulation, current July 2026. Confirm the details that affect you by phone before you count on them.

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